> India. He was therefore most anxious, without reopening this great subject, to urge as earnestly as he could upon the Government a reconsideration of the position they had taken upon this grave question [emphases added].

The Earl of Galloway enthusiastically endorsed this proposal thus:

> The Earl of Galloway
>
> *sincerely hoped the Government would give their earnest attention to the appeal of the right rev. Prelate. It was highly inconsistent with our promise to elevate and improve the condition of the Natives of India if we excluded from our schools in that country the Bible, which was the only standard of right and wrong. It was said that the fear of exciting distrust among the Natives and of weakening our hold upon. India was a necessity for excluding the Bible; but that would imply that we valued the material welfare of England more than we cared for the moral condition of India. In a speech lately delivered by Sir Herbert Edwardes on the propagation of Christianity among the Natives that distinguished officer had expressed opinions which he commended to the consideration of the Government, and which he earnestly hoped would have their due influence* [emphasis added].

It bears noting from the extracted portions here that this discussion took place in 1860, that is, barely under two years of the end of the 1857 Rebellion and the Proclamation of November 1858. If the Proclamation was truly intended to prevent and deter further missionary work in Bharat, the proposal of the Bishop of Oxford proves otherwise. In fact, it demonstrates the artificial separation that the British Christian mind had created for itself. It distinguished between interference with the religion of the natives and the proselytising work carried out by missionaries in Bharat. The latter was not seen as an infraction of the former. This convenient distinction allowed the British coloniser to continue with the façade of neutrality and was further proof of the actual meaning of Christian toleration. It effectively meant ‘Sure, practice your heathen faith but I will continue to denigrate and undermine it through my missionary work until you yield and have a change of heart and conscience.’ That they were utterly convinced of the inextricability of conversion to Christianity and moral improvement of the